IT'S RAINING MUNIFICENCE IN POLL-BOUND GUJARAT. PM NARENDRA MODI, VIRTUALLY THE ONE-MAN CAMPAIGN FACE OF THE BJP, HAS ANNOUNCED OR INAUGURATED PROJECTS WORTH OVER Rs 65,000 CRORE IN JUST TWO MONTHS

By **JUMANA SHAH**



OCTOBER 9-11

MEHSANA

Projects worth:
Rs 3,900 crore

- Multiple infra projects dedicated to the nation. The highlight: Modhera declared India's first 24x7 solar-powered village with over 1,300 rooftop solar plants

Eye on polls: The BJP is trying to consolidate the votes of Patidars, a dominant community in the region. Becharaji seat, where the solar project is located, was ceded to the Congress in 2017

AMOD, BHARUCH

Projects worth:
Rs 8,000 crore

- Bulk drug park at Jambusar and deep sea pipeline project at Dahej
- Phase 1 of Ankleshwar airport and multilevel industrial sheds at Ankleshwar and Panoli

Eye on polls: Bharuch is late Congress strongman Ahmed Patel's hometown. It's also a tribal belt, a part of the 18 per cent electorate that the BJP is trying to woo

JAMNAGAR, SAURASHTRA

Projects worth:
Rs 1,450 crore

- Related to irrigation, power, water supply and urban infrastructure

Eye on polls: The ruling party is making efforts to breach the Congress bastion

AHMEDABAD

Projects worth:
Rs 1,275 crore

- Infrastructure upgrade for various medical facilities at the civil hospital in Asarwa; shelter home for families of poor patients
- PM also inaugurated an educational complex for needy students, being set up by the Modi community

Eye on polls: Most projects cater to lower income groups. Health and education are also the main poll planks of AAP

OCTOBER 19-20

GANDHINAGAR

Projects worth:
Rs 4,260 crore

- Mission Schools of Excellence to strengthen education infra with smart classrooms, computer labs, etc.

Eye on polls: A counter to AAP's perceived USP: the free quality education promise

JUNAGADH AND PORBANDAR

Projects worth:
Rs 3,580 crore

- Coastal highways, sewage and water supply projects
- Fishing port, harbour

Eye on polls: An attempt to woo fishing communities, who belong to the OBC category, a vote bank divided between the Congress and BJP

RAJKOT

Projects worth:
Rs 5,860 crore

- Water supply project, industrial estates
- Flyovers, bridges and other road projects
- Indoor sports complex, regional science centre

Eye on polls: Though it's a traditional BJP stronghold, the party is facing anti-incumbency here among urban and semi-urban voters

VYARA (TAPI) AND NARMADA

Projects worth:
Rs 1,970 crore

- Water supply projects
- Road upgrade from Saputara to the Statue of Unity

Eye on polls: This is a tribal belt, where voters traditionally lean towards the Congress